

Weekly Market Report

Issue 297: Week 4 – May 2026

Highlights

Exchange Rate and Trade Dynamics: During the fourth week of May, the Afghani exchange rate remained stable at AFN 63.8/USD, while remaining stronger than both last year and the three-year average, helping to moderate the impact of imported inflation on domestic markets. Market supply conditions remained generally stable, supported by ongoing domestic harvests and continued imports through regional trade corridors. However, transportation costs, regional trade uncertainties, and high import dependence continue to pose risks to market stability and contribute to localized price fluctuations.

Food Items: Overall, national average food prices remained relatively stable during the fourth week of May, with moderate week-on-week declines across major food commodities. However, compared to last year, most key food commodities continue to remain above year-ago levels, particularly wheat grain (+14%), wheat flour (high-price +9%; low-price +12%), rice (high-quality +38%; low-quality +28%), cooking oil (+4%), sugar (+25%), and salt (+10%). Meanwhile, pulses (-12%) and bread (-4%), remain below their respective levels from the same period last year. The higher year-on-year prices reflect increases recorded between Oct-25 and Mar-26 following border closures with Pakistan and the rerouting of trade through Iran and Central Asia. Since then, improved trade flows and market availability have gradually contributed to declining price levels.

Vegetables: Vegetable prices continued their seasonal decline, supported by increased domestic production and improved market availability. Tomato prices recorded a significant weekly decrease of 18.5%, while potato prices declined by 2.3%. In contrast, onion prices increased by 4.6%, partially reversing the declines observed in recent months and moving back toward more typical seasonal levels. Compared to last year, tomato prices remain 20% lower and onion prices 35% lower, while potato prices continue to remain substantially above last year’s level (+24%). Increased arrivals of seasonal produce from several provinces, continued to improve market availability and support downward price movements across major markets.

Non-Food Items: Diesel prices increased slightly during the week (+1.3%) and remained 14% above last year's level. Fertilizer prices remained broadly stable, with DAP increasing by 0.8% and urea by 0.3% compared to the previous week. Compared to last year, fertilizer prices continue to remain elevated, particularly for urea (+45%) and DAP (+16%), maintaining pressure on agricultural production costs. Improved seed and animal feed prices remained largely unchanged during the week.

Livestock and Labour Market: The price of a one-year-old female sheep increased by 6.0%, driven by stronger demand ahead of Eid-ul-Adha, when livestock purchases typically increase across the country. Meanwhile, labour market conditions remained weak during the week, with labour availability declining slightly to 1.9 days per week, compared to the previous week. Labour availability remains substantially below both last year (-20%) and the three-year average (-16%), reflecting continued constraints in employment opportunities and increased competition among casual labourers.

Weekly Price Changes and Trend Analysis

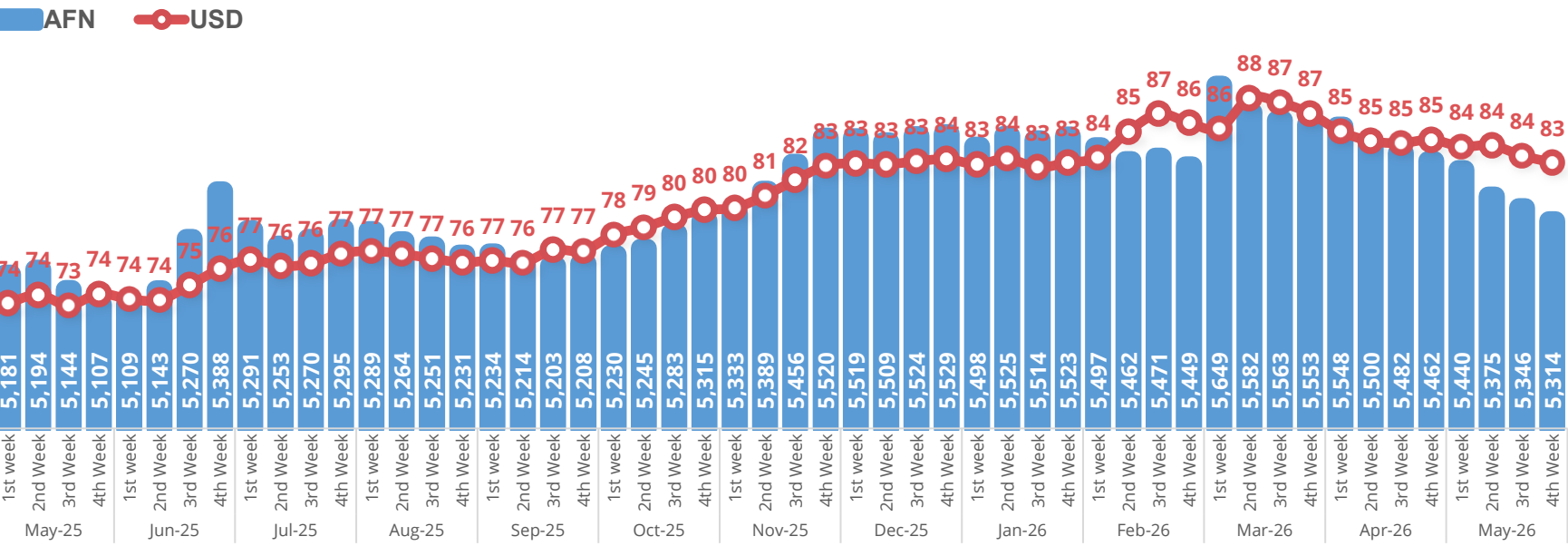
Items	Price This Week	Last Week (%)	Last Year (%)	3-Years Avg. %	Pre-Govt. Transition (%)	Change Since Oct 2025 (%)
Exchange Rate & Food Commodities						
Exchange Rate (AFN/USD)	63.8	0.0%	-9%	-17%	-18%	-4%
Wheat Grain (AFN/Kg)	27	-1.0%	14%	-2%	-12%	10%
Wheat Flour - High price (AFN/Kg)	31	-0.5%	9%	-3%	-7%	3%
Wheat Flour - Low price (AFN/Kg)	29	-0.5%	12%	-1%	-6%	8%
Rice - High Price - "Palawi" (AFN/Kg)	134	-0.7%	38%	28%	52%	30%
Rice - Low Price - "Sholae" (AFN/Kg)	74	0.0%	28%	21%	49%	35%
Cooking Oil (AFN/Kg)	113	-1.0%	4%	5%	-13%	5%
Pulses (AFN/Kg)	90	-0.5%	-12%	-16%	-3%	-7%
Sugar (AFN/Kg)	70	-1.8%	25%	8%	39%	32%
Bread (AFN/Kg)	55	0.0%	-4%	-12%	5%	-4%
Salt (AFN/Kg)	23	0.1%	10%	21%	69%	6%
Tomato (AFN/Kg)	31	-18.5%	-20%	-21%	-19%	-17%
Potato (AFN/Kg)	31	-2.3%	24%	15%	34%	33%
Onion (AFN/Kg)	13	4.6%	-35%	-45%	-33%	-20%
Non-food Commodities						
1-year Old Live Female Sheep (AFN/Head)	8,630	6.0%	3%	6%	13%	8%
Unskilled Labour Wage (AFN/Day)	304	-0.5%	-3%	-3%	-2%	-1%
Skilled Labour Wage (AFN/Day)	653	-0.4%	-2%	0%	0%	0%
Unskilled Labour Availability (Days/Week)	1.9	-2.3%	-20%	-16%	-21%	-14%
Diesel (AFN/Liter)	64.9	1.3%	14%	4%	37%	-17%
Fertilizer - DAP (AFN/50 Kgs)	4,674	0.8%	16%	6%	66%	12%
Fertilizer - Urea (AFN/50 Kgs)	2,300	0.3%	45%	25%	84%	40%
Improved Seed (AFN/50 Kgs)	1,790	0.0%	-3%	-12%	-5%	-4%
Animal Feed (Concentrate) (AFN/100 Kgs)	2,775	-0.1%	-3%	-5%	8%	1%
Casual Labour Wage/Wheat Nominal (Kgs)	10.5	0.0%	-14%	-4%	5%	-8%
Pastoralist Terms of Trade (Kgs)	299	6.5%	-8%	4%	21%	0%

Change in Key Commodity Prices (Week-on-Week)

Provinces displayed for each commodity represent those with the highest percentage change and highest and lowest price in the country

 World Food Programme	 Wheat Grain	 Wheat Flour (High)	 Wheat Flour (Low)	 Rice (Palawi)	 Cooking Oil	 Pulses	 Sugar	 Diesel	 1-Year Alive Female Sheep									
Highest Increase	Kandahar	+9%	Uruzgan	+3%	Logar	+3%	Jawzjan	+3%	Ghor	+5%	Baghlan	+5%	Nuristan	+2%	Wardak	+7%	Badakhshan	+44%
Highest Decrease	Badghis	-11%	Hirat	-6%	Hilmand	-4%	Khost	-8%	Bamyan	-10%	Panjshir	-4%	Faryab	-13%	Paktika	-3%	Takhar	+22%
Highest Price - AFN	Ghor	35	Nuristan	38	Nuristan	35	Nuristan	175	Nimroz	133	Nuristan	133	Nuristan	82	Nuristan	72	Baghlan	13,000
Lowest Price - AFN	Nimroz	21	Baghlan	28	Farah	25	Paktika	95	Kabul	100	Takhar	62	Kandahar	59	Zabul	58	Daykundi	6,000

WFP Food Basket Prices



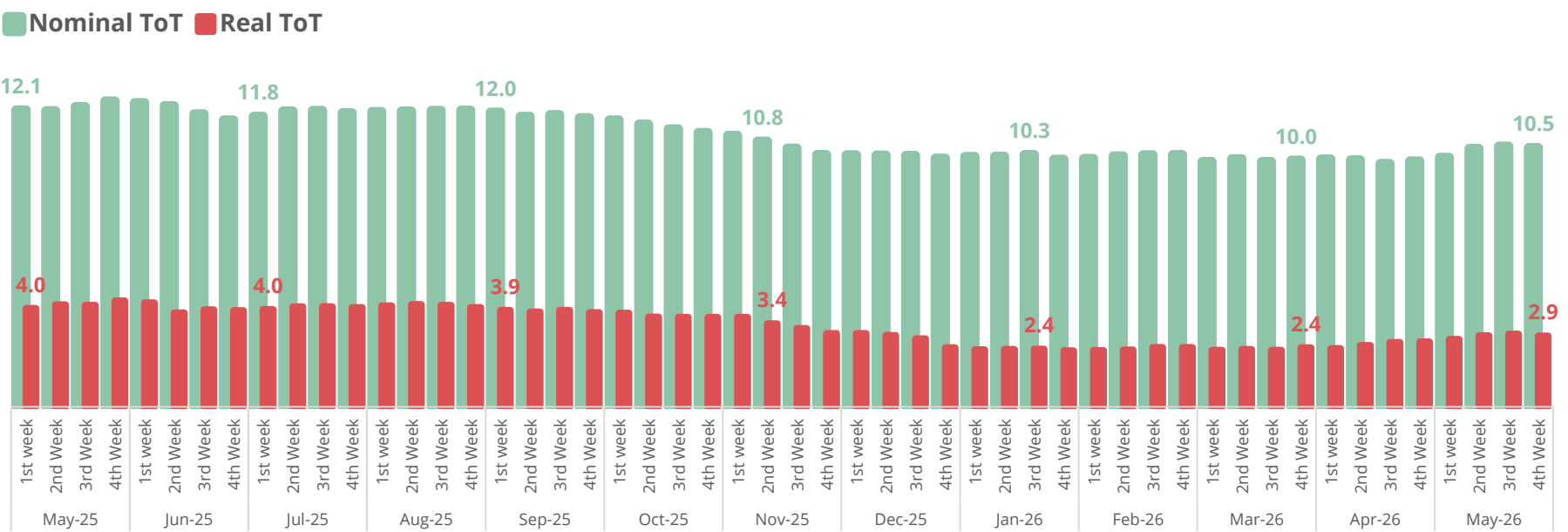
Trigger Analysis for Transfer Value (TV) Revision

Last TV Revision: May 2024 - 5,800 AFN

May 2026 4th Week	Current Prices	Consecutive Weeks ≥ 10% to <20% of TV (+/-)	Consecutive Weeks Increase ≥ 20% of TV (+/-)	Percentage Change in TV
FSAC Food Basket (AFN)	5,961	0	0	+2.8%

Triggers are for Transfer Value (TV) revision. Triggers are thresholds for the number of consecutive weeks that the national average price of the FSAC food basket in AFN has increased or decreased in comparison to the most recent TV by a minimum proportion: four consecutive weeks for a price change of ≥ 20% and eight consecutive weeks for ≥ 10%.

Casual Labour Wage/Wheat Flour Nominal and Real Terms of Trade (ToT)

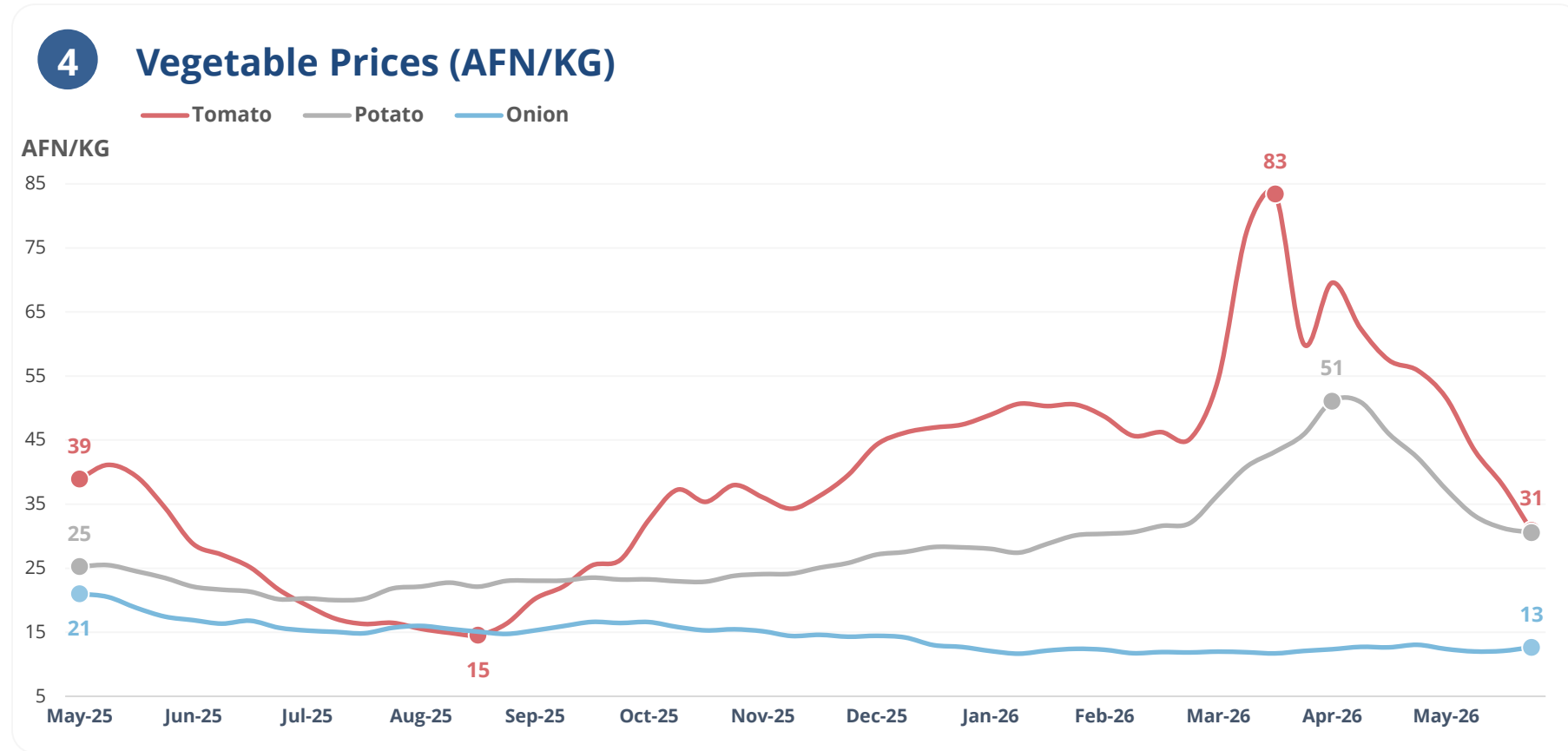
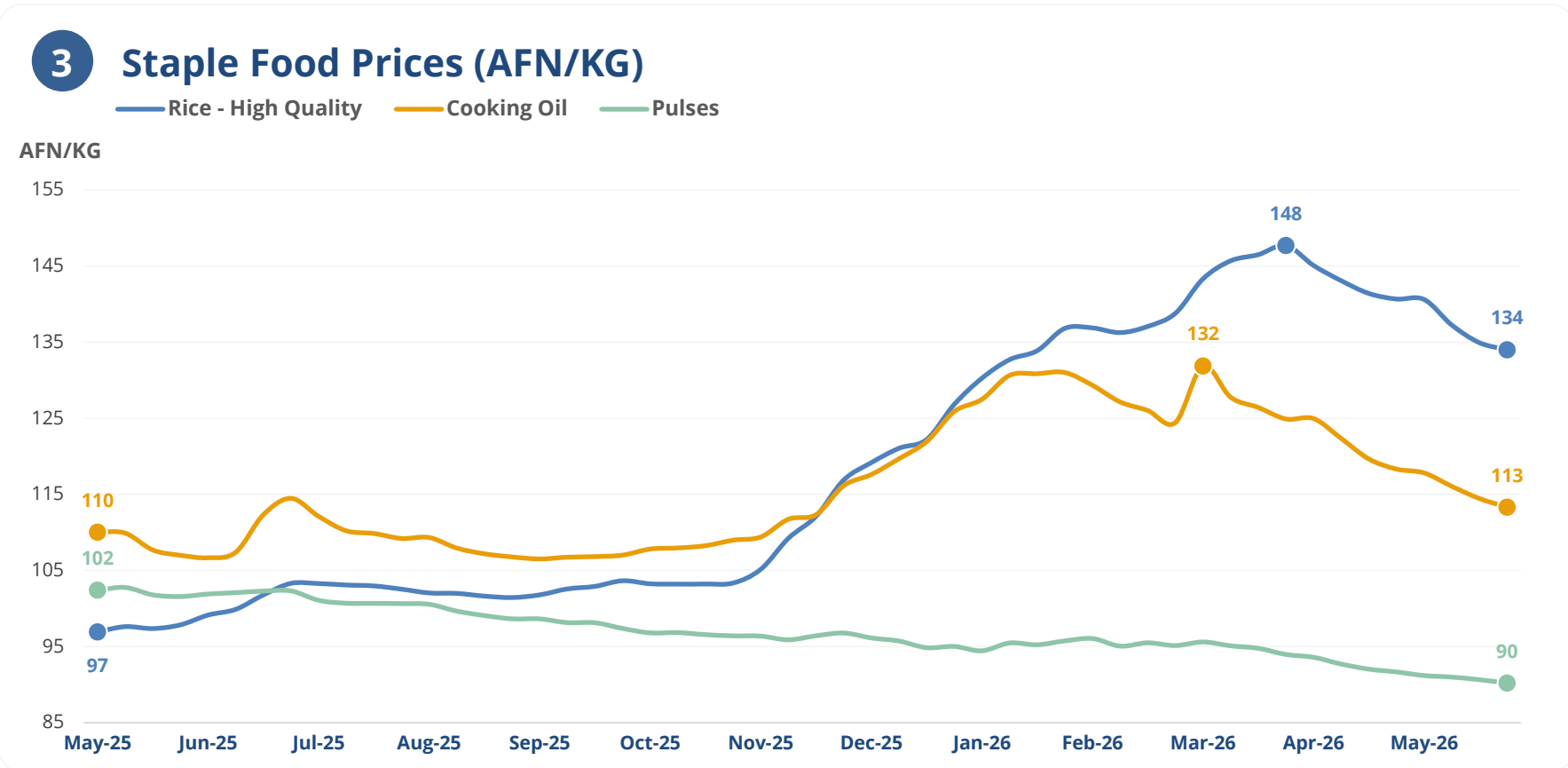
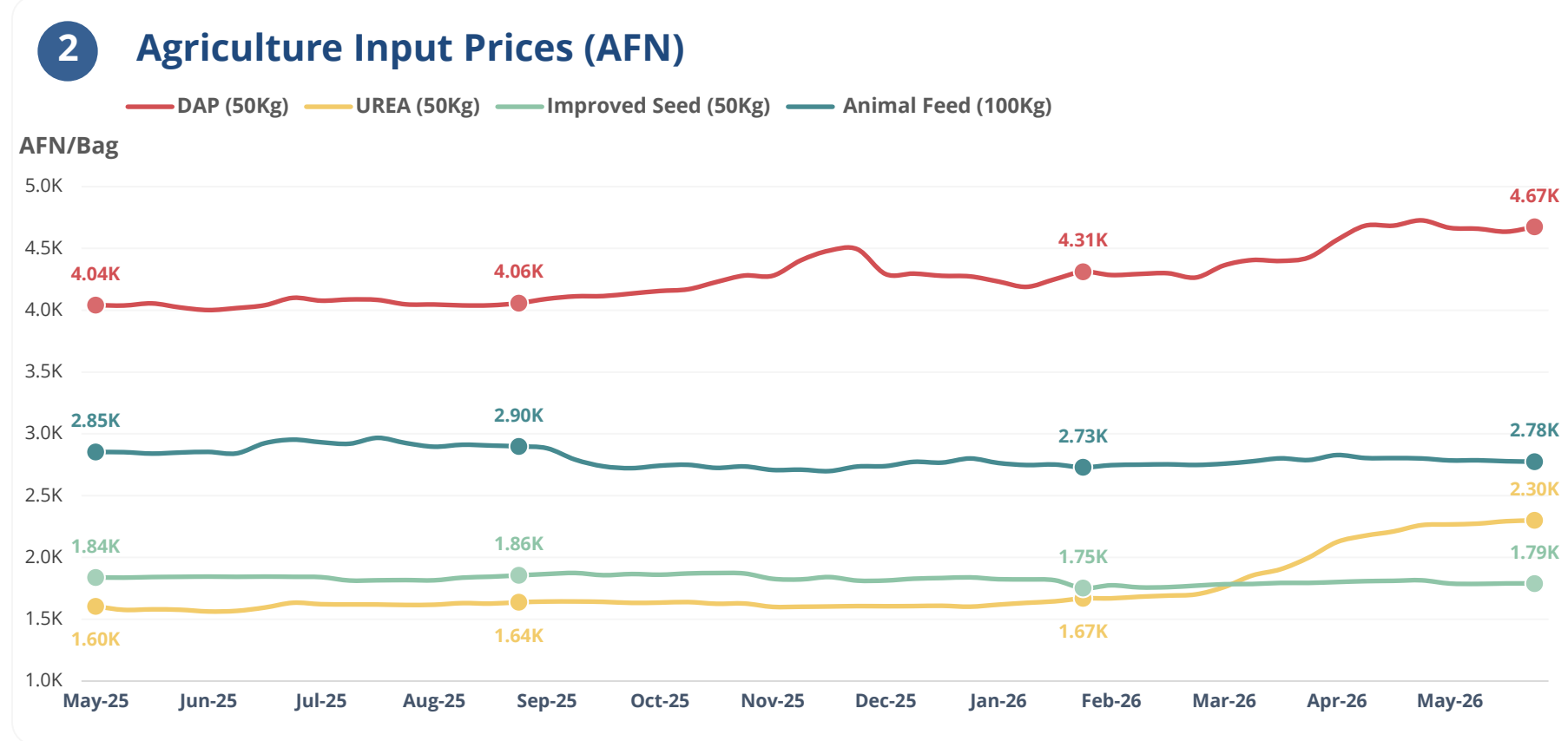
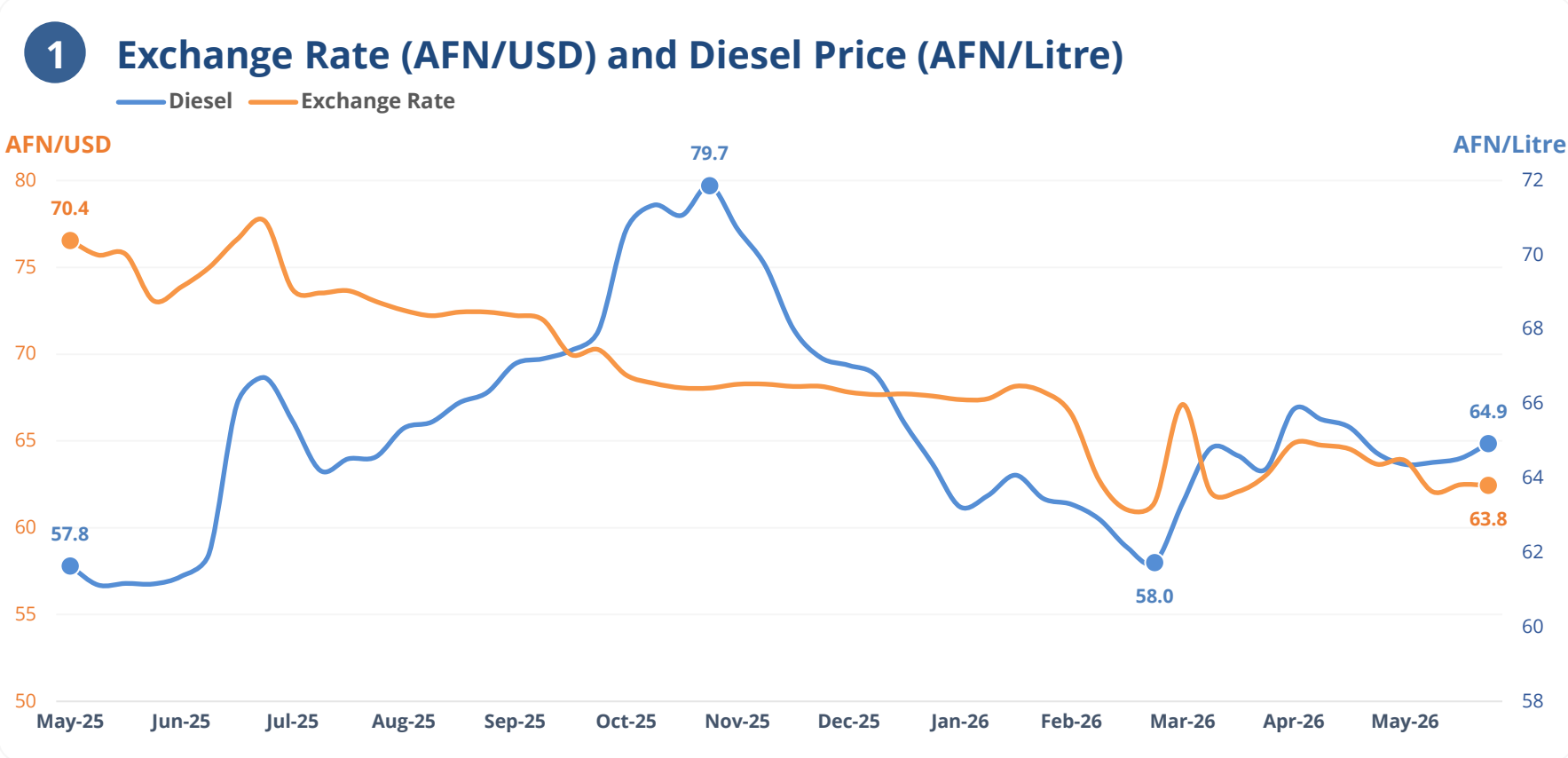


Nominal Terms of Trade (ToT): The nominal ToT remained stable compared to last week at 10.5 kg of wheat flour (low price) per casual labour wage, reflecting stable market conditions. However, the ToT remains weak compared to last year and the three-year average by 14% and 4%, respectively, indicating a deterioration in the purchasing power of labour-dependent households.

Real Terms of Trade (ToT): Real ToT experienced a slight decline of 2.3% compared to last week, driven by the decline in labour availability prior to Eid holidays. Meanwhile, it stands 31% and 20% below last year and the three-year average, respectively. Persistently limited employment opportunities, driven by increased demand from returnees, combined with rising food prices, continue to constrain the purchasing power of labour-dependent households, limiting their ability to meet minimum food needs.

National Average Price Trends – Key Commodities

May 2025 – May 2026 (Weekly)





Notes

- WFP collects price data weekly from all 34 provincial capitals through third-party monitors. Monthly prices are the average of the four weekly prices.
- WFP reports on two types of rice in Afghanistan—Palawi, a long-grain variety that is generally preferred, more expensive, and primarily imported, and Sholae, a short-grain variety that is generally less preferred, cheaper, and more commonly sourced domestically. There are no significant nutritional differences between these types..
- The price of pulses is the average of the prices of lentils, chickpeas, and red beans.
- Pastoralist Terms of Trade (ToT) captures the purchasing power of the households that own or have access to livestock. It indicates how many kilograms of wheat flour can be obtained by selling a one-year-old female sheep.
- Real Unskilled Labour Terms of Trade (ToT) captures the purchasing power of unskilled labourers. It indicates the number of kilograms of wheat flour that can be obtained with the average daily wage for unskilled labour, adjusted for the average number of working days per week in the market. Whereas the nominal ToT for unskilled labour doesn't include the number of working days and instead calculates the average daily wage of casual labour relative to the average price of wheat flour.
- The Terms of Trade (ToT) is calculated using the price of wheat flour (low quality).
- Casual Labour: Casual labourers typically lack specific skills and are hired by the hour or day, or for specific tasks, and are paid at a lower rate than skilled labourers.
- In the price table, positive changes denote a decrease in prices, whereas negative changes indicate an increase in the price level (from the consumer's perspective). For ToT and Labour wages, the scale is reversed: positive change indicates improvement, and negative change indicates decline.
- The colour coding is as follows: Grey for negligible changes ($\pm < 2\%$ weekly, $\pm < 5\%$ monthly/yearly), Dark Blue for significant positive changes ($\pm \geq 5\%$ weekly, $\pm \geq 10\%$ monthly/yearly), Pale Blue for slight positive changes ($\pm \geq 2\%$ weekly, $\pm \geq 5\%$ monthly/yearly), Pale Red for slight negative changes ($\pm \geq 2\%$ weekly, $\pm \geq 5\%$ monthly/yearly), and Dark Red for significant negative changes ($\pm \geq 5\%$ weekly, $\pm \geq 10\%$ monthly/yearly).

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